

I was getting my degree in accounting and management, so I decided to see if I had learned anything. I determined how much the spare parts were worth and made a proposal to Aeronutronic that they purchase the spare parts (by this time Ford Motor Co. had purchased Philco Corp., so Aeronutronic and Philco were both part of Ford Motor Co.) and hire me part-time to tend to the repair needs of the small computer system. It was a slam dunk when they saw how much they would save with little to no risk. In that position, I came in about 7 am, went to the cafeteria next door to the computer facility for breakfast, then checked out the equipment and retired to my technical space to study and do my homework. About 11:30 am I went back to the cafeteria and had lunch, made one more inspection of the equipment and then went to Long Beach State for classes. Another great set-up because I was single at the time. I completed my bachelor's degree at the same time the use of the small computer was discontinued. Now to get a job with a Certified Public Accounting (CPA) firm. Long Beach State held a career day near graduation whereas students could interview with prospective employers. This was the early '70s before age discrimination laws. I was 33 at the time. I interviewed with all of the "Big Eight Accounting Firms" as they were known then. They were very forthright in telling me I was too old! We want a person less than 25, with a wife and kids, a mortgage and car payments and a picture of his wife and kids on his desk so he will say "YES" to the long hours we will ask him to work for little pay. (You had to work two years for a CPA firm to qualify for a CPA license, so they had the leverage.) A guy your age will balk at that, so we will not hire you. Shortly after my last scheduled interview, I ran into the man that organized the career fair and he asked how my interviews were going. I told what I had experienced. He thought he could get me an interview with a CPA firm in the next lower tier of larger CPA firms during their lunch break. He made the arrangements and I went to the interview with two representatives of the firm. I decided I would take the lead in this interview. I walked in and said, "I am 33 years old and if that is a problem for you, let's go have lunch and I will buy!" Almost shocked them out of their chairs, but they said, "Let's chat about you here now." I got hired. I worked for this firm almost 4 years doing audits and other accounting work for various clients in many different industries. Toward the end of my third year, a partner came to me on a Friday and said, "Gary do you have any experience doing percentage of completion accounting? I have a construction client that wants to begin having an annual audit. I want you to work with this client. Come to the office tomorrow and I will teach you percentage of completion accounting." I think you may be able to guess who the client was, Raymond. I did work at Raymond and other clients for the CPA firm until August 1976. In August 1976 I became controller at Raymond. I had to convince Carl I would not run off after a short time. I was divorced, since 1968, and Carl said he had been burned when he had hired previous divorced men who later ran off chasing a woman. I convinced Carl I would not do that to him, and he hired me. I married Kay in October 1981 without running off. I am writing this in October 2020, and we are beginning our 40th year together. I never dreamed of running Raymond. In a family-owned company, if there is a family member